

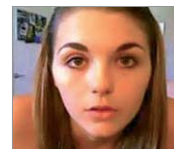
Some People...

A man on trial, in a Californian court, decided to steal computers from the court house itself. Jon Eipp, 39, claimed he wanted help with his drug problems and sanity, and stole to attract attention. Incidentally, he was on trial for computer theft!



Lonelygirl15

www.lonelygirl15.com, an Internet-TV reality show, says that it will use only Open Source software to power its project. People were buzzing about this site, but we really didn't see the point of it. So she's lonely, and on the Internet. How original!



Escape

THE DEATH OF AN IPOD

Here Come The iKillers!

Oh, so many people and huge corporations would jump for joy; if that ever happened! Products are like Arab dictators, and if they get too loud and popular, chances are there will be coups and attempts to be overthrown, and attacks from the bushes!

The iPod may have sparked a revolution, started a religion, united the masses and spawned a whole new segment of products... but it's going down, baby! Or so the following products are hoping you will believe...

SanDisk, a well known Flash memory manufacturer, recently launched the Sansa e200 series of portable media devices. The series will have 2, 4, 6 and 8 GB variants, will play music, display pictures, and also play movie clips, apart from having an FM tuner. They're being pitted against the iPod nano, and will tie up with Real

Networks' Rhapsody service to take on Apple's iTunes.

The Sansa e200 series players come with one major difference from the nano: they have a microSD card slot, so you can add to the existing memory—as much as 2 GB more!

Another contender is Microsoft's soon-to-be-released Zune player, which has 30 GB of space, plays everything, and also throws in Wi-Fi connectivity so users can share media!

Seems everyone is jumping onto this wagon, and Apple's got a fight on its hands. However, considering that iPod alternatives have been around longer than the iPod itself, and no-one has dethroned it yet, perhaps the millions of happy iPeople won't even notice that their coolness is under threat!

Will Apple lose to any of the challengers? Is it mean for us, the media, to be

pitting every new personal audio device against the almighty iPod? Should we stop? Hell no! Stay tuned to this space for updates on World War III!

ALL TIED-UP

What's With All The Tie-Ups?

If you believe in Big Brother, this is not a good time to be alive! The biggest corporations seem to have lost that competitive edge, and are adopting the "share the spoils" attitude! Conspiracy theories abound, and everyone is "partnering" with everyone else to take over the world! First it was the Yahoo! + MSN Messenger service tie-up, which was good,

Whatever Happened To...

BeOS?

In the wave of alternative OSes—which eventually boiled down to just Linux and the BSDs—BeOS was much-touted as the golden boy for multimedia, whether it involved creating it or viewing it.

Unfortunately, it turned out that that was *all* that BeOS was good at. It had no native video drivers, and at a time when even Linux didn't support most peripherals, expecting a nondescript, off-beat OS to have them was a stretch of optimism. BeOS was built for specific machines, and ran well on them—few others were so lucky.

Another thing that did BeOS in, probably as a result of its small audience, was poor application support. Very little software was developed for the platform, as is the case today. So did the OS just die? BeOS eventually sold out to Palm, those people are now involved in the development of Palm's OS.

Still, the fire remains. As in many such cases, BeOS still remains supported by a healthy community, which keeps developing new applications for the system and even ports new applications to it. You will find them at www.bebits.com, and you can even download the BeOS 5 Personal Edition—the last officially-released version. For all intents and purposes, BeOS is now, more than ever, the enthusiast's OS.

Win! My Desktop

Last month's winner is Kailash from Bangalore. His Desktop was a tad gaudy, but Kailash's age (14) worked in his favour—and he seems to have done some fiddling around! Kailash used Alpha Xp, icons from CrystalXp.net, the Clear Clock .dxdpack, and the Silica MP3 Player Widget.

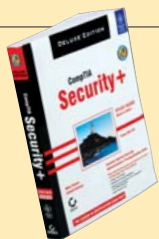
Congratulations!

Participate in this contest and win next month

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Send your Desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject "My Desktop", and tell us your postal address, too.